

Fuji FinePix F410

Much glitter, no gold

Fujifilm's FinePix F410 is equipped with a 3.1 megapixel Super CCD. It can pack in a 3 megapixel image size that can be boosted to 6 megapixels using the fourth-generation Super CCD.

The F410 sports a complete metallic body, with clean running lines. Sliding a raised panel on the front switches the camera on, lighting the three blue neon lights. The back of the camera has a neat and clean design, with a good thumb grip. The buttons for menu selection and other settings are placed near the LCD monitor. Due to its metallic body, the F410 does not provide a firm confident grip, and is likely to slip.

Despite its small size, it has no dearth of features. You can select from seven pre-defined

white balance settings, or set it to shoot in auto mode. The camera's shutter speeds range from 1/2 a second, to 1/2000 of a second—enough to take photographs under any conditions. The F410 supports ISO

speeds ranging from 200 to 1600—sufficient enough to increase the CCD gain, in case you want to shoot at night.

In performance, the F410 could not live up to the reputations built by other Fuji cameras—especially the S304. The F410 took a severe beating in colour reproduction, where the deviation was more than 10 per cent for all the three colours. The camera wasn't able to pick up variations properly, leading to a poor score in the specular effect and gradation test.

Similarly, in the details test, the camera just could not pick up any sort of fine details. The only saving grace was the RGB target test, where the F410 clawed back to its feet by reproducing the colours decently. In the zoom test and the actual person test, the results were worse. Despite the 3X optical zoom, the F410 seems to be quite ineffective in capturing targets that are some distance off. In the actual person test, the photograph turned out quite dark, and showed varying shades of white, indicating poor white balance response.

Priced at Rs 35,000, one does not expect such a poor performance. For the same price range, you should consider the S304.

+ Compact form factor
– Extremely over priced
Price: Rs 35,000

Fuji FinePix F410		B-	
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Ergonomics	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■

Fuji F601

Expensive mediocrity

The Fuji F601 has good looks but is hard to operate. Operating the zoom and shutter buttons puts the thumb and forefinger at awkward angles—uncomfortable while taking a photograph.

The F601 has a 3.1 megapixel Super CCD sensor, with a 3X optical zoom and 4.4X digital zoom. Eight white balance settings, and a shutter speed ranging from 1/2 a second to 1/2000 of a second, help snap in all lighting conditions.



In the standard image test, the F601 was able to reproduce the test scene well, without saturating colours. The average colour deviation was not good—less than 7 per cent for red, and more than 10 per cent for blue and green. The images were vibrant, with uniform luminance across the entire frame. The F601 reproduced mild specular effects, but was able to reproduce the gradations perfectly well.

In the details test, it was good at colour reproduction, but lost ground when it came to picking up finer details such as the wrinkles, etc.

In the RGB target test, the camera was better than all its Fuji and Canon counterparts. This was the only test where the F601 excelled, and perfectly reproduced the RGB target with great precision. In the zoom test too, the F601 gave fine results, losing only to the Canon IXUS 400. However, in the actual person test, the F601 performed badly, yielding photographs that looked quite dark.

Overall, it's a good camera, marred by a shoddy design, but is inexcusably over priced.

"Excellent quality of images, but am still trying to figure out how to hold the camera. Looks nice on the table, yet feels funny in the hand with it's ergonomics. But thankfully one can switch off the display even when shooting and conserve precious battery power. At 47,500, for most Indians it will be a back bencher. And yes!, will make excellent pictures for the super-sleuth Bond photographer better known as the Paparazzi. "

—Sherwin Crasto

+ High resolutions and ISO speeds
– Over priced
Price: Rs 47,500

Fuji F601		C+	
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Ergonomics	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■